Holden Holden EJ / EH / HD / HR (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/2

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Holden | Model: Holden EJ / EH / HD / HR | Australian Market Years: 1962-1968
Vehicle Type: Sedan / Station Sedan / Utility / Panel Van | Segment: Large | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Fishermans Bend, Victoria, Dandenong, Victoria, Elizabeth, South Australia, Woodvil

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The 1962-1968 era represents the golden age of 1960s Holden dominance. The July 1962 EJ introdu ced clean, modern European-inspired styling, the milestone 1,000,000th Holden produced, and the prestigious Premier luxury model with standard automatic, leather bucket seats, and metallic p aint. In August 1963, the legendary EH debuted Holden's all-new, world-class 'Red Motor' inline -six?featuring a 7-bearing crankshaft, hydraulic lifters, and 149ci (2.4L) and 179ci (2.9L) cap acities. The EH became Australia's fastest-selling car ever, selling over 250,000 units in 18 m onths and claiming podium fame at Mount Panorama with the EH S4 Bathurst homologation special. The 1965 HD brought wider passenger accommodations and the twin-carburettor X2 engine, while th e April 1966 HR resolved styling with crisp modern lines, front disc brakes, wider track, and t he 186S engine with twin-barrel Bendix-Stromberg WW carburettor.

The introduction of the Red Motor in the EH transformed Holden's engineering standing worldwide , vastly outclassing Ford's Falcon sixes in thermal endurance and high-speed reliability. In 19 66, the HR series pioneered critical Australian safety engineering with front lap-sash seatbelt mountings, padded dash, shatter-resistant mirror, and front disc brakes as an option (standard on Premier). Over 1,020,000 units were produced across the EJ, EH, HD, and HR models.

SERIES / GENERATION: EJ (EJ Series) [1962-1963]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None
Lower, squarer modern styling, marked the 1,000,000th Holden built, and introduced the luxuriou s Premier nameplate. Final application of the Grey motor.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Grey-138-EJ: 2.26L (2262cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 56.0 kW / 163.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- EJ Special: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, 3-speed Hydra-Matic automatic, AUD $2100-$23
- EJ Premier: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed Hydra-Matic automatic, AUD $2700-$2850, Fuel=10.8L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* EJ Premier | Sedan | Grey-138-EJ | 3-speed Hydra-Matic automatic | RWD | 56.0kW/163.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: EH (EH Series) [1963-1965]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None
Historic launch of the 7-bearing Red Motor (149ci & 179ci). Re-profiled roofline, square rear b oot and tail lights. Fastest selling car in Australian history with 256,959 units sold.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Red-149: 2.4L (2442cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 75.0 kW / 197.0 Nm
- Red-179: 2.9L (2934cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 86.0 kW / 237.0 Nm
- Red-179-S4: 2.9L (2934cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 89.0 kW / 245.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- EH Special: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, Hydra-Matic 3-speed automatic, AUD $2150-$24
- EH Premier: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=Hydra-Matic 3-speed automatic, AUD $2780-$2950, Fuel=11.2L/100km

- EH Special S4: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $2490-$2550, Fuel=11.5L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* EH Special | Sedan | Red-149 | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 75.0kW/197.0Nm
* EH Premier | Sedan | Red-179 | Hydra-Matic 3-speed automatic | RWD | 86.0kW/237.0Nm
* EH Special S4 | Sedan | Red-179-S4 | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 89.0kW/245.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: HD (HD Series) [1965-1966]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None

Introduced wider body with curved side glass, kidney front fenders, front disc brakes option, P
owerglide 2-speed automatic, and the twin-carburettor X2 high-performance engine.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Red-149-HD: 2.4L (2442cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 75.0 kW / 197.0 Nm
- Red-179-HD: 2.9L (2934cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 86.0 kW / 237.0 Nm
- Red-179-X2: 2.9L (2934cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 104.0 kW / 241.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- HD Premier: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=Powerglide 2-speed automatic, AUD $2860-$3100, Fuel=11.4L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* HD Premier | Sedan | Red-179-X2 | Powerglide 2-speed automatic | RWD | 104.0kW/241.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: HR (HR Series) [1966-1968]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door coupe utility, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None

Crisp squared styling, wider track, ball-joint front suspension, standard front disc brakes on
Premier, and introduced the high-output 186S engine with twin-barrel carburettor and 4-speed ma
nual.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Red-161: 2.6L (2638cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 85.0 kW / 213.0 Nm
- Red-186: 3.0L (3048cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 94.0 kW / 245.0 Nm
- Red-186S: 3.0L (3048cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 108.0 kW / 249.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- HR Special: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, 4-speed manual floor, Powerglide 2-speed aut
- HR Premier: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=Powerglide 2-speed automatic, 4-speed manual floor, AUD $2890-$3220
- HR 186S: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, Powerglide 2-speed automatic, AUD $2680-$2980, F

Factory Configurations:

* HR Premier | Sedan | Red-186 | Powerglide 2-speed automatic | RWD | 94.0kW/245.0Nm
* HR 186S | Sedan | Red-186S | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 108.0kW/249.0Nm